

HELMETED LIZARDS

Nine species of arboreal lizards from Central and South America constitute the family Corytophanidae. They are closely related to the iguanas. All species have a well-developed head crest. Long legs and a long tail allow these lizards to run at high speeds to evade predators.



GREEN BASILISK *Basiliscus plumifrons*

Native to C. American rainforests, this species inhabits river banks. The crests on its head, back, and tail are supported by bony spines.

65 cm
26 in

long legs

long tail aids balance when climbing or running

bright orange iris

sail-like dorsal crest

HELMETED IGUANA *Corytophanes cristatus*

This C. American iguana lives on a diet of large arthropods. By feeding infrequently, it minimizes the time it spends in the open or is conspicuous to predators.

34 cm
13½ in

hard, cone-like casque at rear of head

EASTERN CASQUE-HEADED IGUANA *Laemantus longipes*

This large, insectivorous species lives in small groups of one male and two to three females. It is native to C. America.

slender green feet and legs

70 cm
28 in

NORTH AMERICAN SPINY LIZARDS

Restricted to North and Central America, the Phrynosomatidae are a diverse family of lizards that prefer arid environments and hunt insects. They are generally small, dull coloured, and spiny. Most lay eggs, but those living at high altitudes are viviparous.



GREEN SPINY LIZARD *Sceloporus malachiticus*

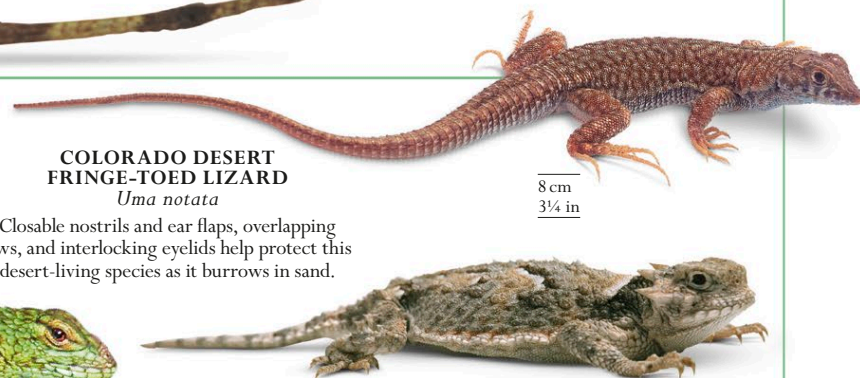
This diurnal, arboreal lizard from C. America has stiff, keeled scales, which give it a spiny appearance.

20 cm
8 in

COLORADO DESERT FRINGE-TOED LIZARD *Uma notata*

Closable nostrils and ear flaps, overlapping jaws, and interlocking eyelids help protect this desert-living species as it burrows in sand.

8 cm
3¼ in



DESERT HORNED LIZARD *Phrynosoma platyrhinos*

This lizard of N. American deserts primarily eats ants. Its flattened body is an adaptation to maximize heat absorption while basking in the sun.

15 cm
6 in

IGUANAS

Largely confined to the Americas, the Iguanidae number nearly 30 species in 8 genera. They are diverse in colour. Most are diurnal, carnivorous predators, although larger species are herbivorous. They all lay eggs.



BLACK IGUANA *Ctenosaura similis*

This gregarious species from C. America lives in colonies with a dominant male. Although usually herbivorous, it sometimes eats small lizards.

90 cm
35 in

long, whip-like tail

GREEN IGUANA *Iguana iguana*

Widespread in C. and S. America, this large iguana is herbivorous. Males defend their territory by vigorously nodding their heads to display dominance.

dorsal crest

2 m
6½ ft

MARINE IGUANA
Amblyrhynchus cristatus
Native to the Galapagos Islands, this aquatic lizard is well adapted to feeding on underwater algae. Nasal glands help remove salt.